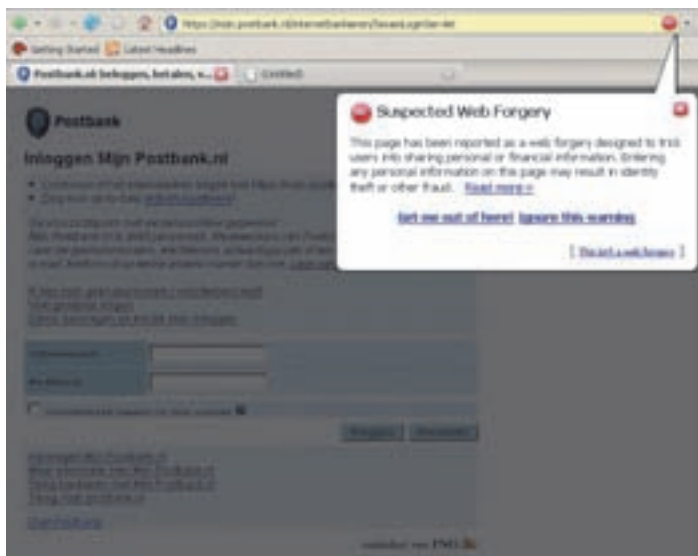




Most browsers give out a warning when suspicious activities are detected

search engine.

- A scammer can direct you to a real company's web site, but then an unauthorised pop-up screen created by the scammer will appear, with blanks in which to provide your personal information. Never provide information in these. Installing pop-up blocking software helps prevent this.
- A spam filter can help reduce the number of scam mails you get. Anti-virus software as explained earlier can scan for malicious files and report any suspicious activity taking place on your PC. Firewalls will prevent unauthorised communications from entering your computer. Look for programs that offer automatic updates and take advantage of free patches that manufacturers offer to fix newly discovered problems.

Most browsers these days maintain a list of known scam sites and check web sites against the list. Mozilla Firefox 2 onwards uses Google's anti-phishing software, which has found be more effective than Internet Explorer 7 onwards in detecting fraudulent sites.